ENG-0017: System Postmortem for inventory-worker

Impact

The incident involving the inventory-worker system, identified as system ID SYS-024, resulted in a Sev3 severity level disruption. The system's criticality is classified as medium, and the incident caused operational delays within the associated processes. The resolution required a total of 33.5 hours, impacting project timelines and resource allocation for Project Ironwood.

Timeline

The incident was reported by employee E-094 and logged under incident ID INC-069. Following the report, the issue was addressed over a span of 33.5 hours before resolution. The system is owned by Project Ironwood, which is currently on hold as of the latest update. The project started on 2025-04-16, under the ownership of project lead Joshua Cooke.

Root Cause

The root cause of the incident was capacity exhaustion within the inventory-worker system. This capacity exhaustion led to system instability and operational delays, necessitating intervention to restore normal functionality.

Action Items

- Review and optimize system capacity planning to prevent future capacity exhaustion.
- Monitor system performance regularly, especially during peak usage periods.
- Ensure that the on-call engineer, Lawrence Adkins, is prepared for rapid response to similar incidents.
- Document and implement preventative measures based on the root cause analysis to mitigate recurrence.

Additional Notes

Lawrence Adkins, a Staff Engineer located in Sydney, is designated as the on-call employee for inventory-worker. The system is built using React, Node.js, and DynamoDB, supporting its medium criticality status. The owning project, Project Ironwood, is managed by Joshua Cooke, a Financial Analyst based in Melbourne. The project is currently on hold, with vendor ID V-007 involved in its development.

This postmortem aims to inform ongoing maintenance and incident response strategies to enhance system reliability and operational efficiency within the enterprise.